

# Multilingual Immigration Legal Aid, Advocacy & Bond Resources (U.S.)

## Legal Aid & Immigration Defense

Across the United States, numerous nonprofit legal service organizations offer **free or low-cost immigration defense**. These groups help immigrants in detention or facing deportation, often providing assistance in **multiple languages**. Many cover specific regions or case types (e.g. asylum, family reunification, removal defense), and some are national in scope. Key resources include:

- **National Legal Aid Directories:** The *National Immigration Legal Services Directory* allows users to search by state or detention center for nonprofit legal aid providers. This directory includes only free/low-cost services and is accessible in multiple languages <sup>1</sup> <sup>2</sup>. It provides contact information and notes each organization's **jurisdictions served, case specialties, and language support**. CivicSALT can link to this directory to help users find local legal help by ZIP code or state.
- **Major Nonprofit Legal Providers:** Examples of established immigration legal aid organizations:
  - **National Immigrant Justice Center (NIJC):** Based in Chicago with offices in other states, NIJC provides representation to detained immigrants and asylum seekers (jurisdictions: IL, IN, WI, etc.). Services are available in English and Spanish (and other languages via interpreters).
  - **Kids in Need of Defense (KIND):** A national organization with offices across the U.S., focusing on unaccompanied children's deportation defense. They coordinate pro bono attorneys and provide materials in English and Spanish.
  - **Catholic Charities / CLINIC Affiliates:** Catholic Legal Immigration Network, Inc. (CLINIC) supports **hundreds of local Catholic Charities** immigration programs nationwide. These affiliates offer help with family visas, DACA, deportation defense, etc., typically with **multilingual staff** (Spanish and often other languages common to local immigrant communities).
- **Local Legal Aid Societies:** Many general legal aid organizations have immigration units. For example, the Legal Aid Foundation of Los Angeles (LAFLA) assists with asylum, DACA, VAWA, and more, with services offered in *multiple languages* <sup>3</sup>. Similar programs exist in other cities (e.g. New York Legal Aid Society, etc.).
- **Publicly-Funded Defense Programs:** In some areas, local governments fund deportation defense for those who cannot afford an attorney. Vera Institute's SAFE Network, for instance, has helped establish such programs in **state and local jurisdictions** <sup>4</sup>. While not directly accessible via a single link, CivicSALT might inform users if their city/state offers a **"universal representation"** program and how to access it.

Each organization typically provides an external website (often with **online intake forms or phone intake**). Many offer bilingual intake in English/Spanish; some support additional languages (either via bilingual staff

or interpreter lines). For example, a Los Angeles resource guide notes that local nonprofits like LAFLA and CHIRLA serve clients in multiple languages <sup>5</sup>. Users should be encouraged to contact these organizations or use the national directory to find appropriate local support.

## Advocacy & Know-Your-Rights Resources

A variety of advocacy groups and coalitions provide **“Know Your Rights” (KYR)** education, emergency planning tools, and rapid response support to prepare immigrants for encounters with Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE):

- **Immigrant Legal Resource Center (ILRC):** ILRC produces *Red Cards* – small cards asserting the holder’s constitutional rights (to remain silent, refuse entry without a warrant, etc.) to hand to ICE agents. These Red Cards are available in **39 languages**, including Spanish, Korean, Chinese, Tagalog, Farsi, and more <sup>6</sup>. ILRC also offers family emergency planning guides and preparedness checklists in multiple languages <sup>7</sup>, plus printable posters and flyers about rights (English/Spanish). These resources help families prepare **regardless of location**, and CivicSALT could link to ILRC’s multilingual materials for broad use.
- **“We Have Rights” Campaign:** A multimedia empowerment campaign by several advocacy groups (including the **Brooklyn Defender Services** and ACLU) that provides step-by-step videos on handling ICE interactions. The videos cover scenarios like ICE at the door, in public, or during an arrest, and are available in **eight languages: English, Spanish, French, Arabic, Mandarin, Haitian Creole, Russian, and Urdu** <sup>8</sup>. This resource is highly accessible for diverse communities and can be linked in the app’s KYR section for easy viewing.
- **American Civil Liberties Union (ACLU):** The ACLU offers general immigrants’ rights guides and wallet cards. Their materials (e.g. “Know Your Rights: What to Do If Stopped by ICE or Police”) are provided in multiple languages (historically English, Spanish, Arabic, Chinese, and others) <sup>9</sup> <sup>10</sup>. ACLU’s resources emphasize that **constitutional rights apply to all persons** in the U.S. – for example, the right to remain silent and to refuse entry to one’s home without a warrant. These core advisories are uniform nationwide <sup>11</sup>. CivicSALT can link to ACLU’s KYR pages or PDFs, which often include **printable cards** and **video explainers**.
- **Immigrant Defense Project (IDP):** Based in New York but providing national resources, IDP focuses on defending immigrant communities against deportation and aggressive enforcement. IDP publishes **“Know Your Rights” booklets and flyers** (in English and Spanish) about how to respond to ICE raids or arrests. They also maintain an ICE activity hotline and an **ICE raid map** to track enforcement patterns. (IDP’s general KYR guides are cited by experts alongside ACLU’s materials as go-to resources <sup>12</sup>.)
- **United We Dream (UWD):** The largest immigrant youth-led network, active nationally. UWD provides KYR training and resources (in English and Spanish) via its **Deportation Defense** program. They offer a **“MigraWatch” hotline** to report ICE raids and formerly ran the **Notifica** app (for alerting family/legal contacts during an ICE encounter). UWD’s online guides give practical tips (e.g. not carrying foreign ID, how to make an emergency plan) and emphasize community support during enforcement actions <sup>13</sup> <sup>14</sup>. CivicSALT might include UWD’s checklists for at-home, public, or workplace ICE encounters, which are actionable and available to a broad audience.

- **LawHelp.org – Immigration:** LawHelp (a project of Pro Bono Net) has an **Immigration Legal Help** portal with plain-language articles about immigrants’ legal options and rights nationwide <sup>15</sup>. It also links to state-by-state information. This can serve as a general knowledge hub for users, covering topics like asylum, detention, and the immigration court process, with referrals to local organizations.
- **Community Preparedness Campaigns:** Many cities and states have coalitions that run **rapid response networks** and outreach in multiple languages. For instance, the *Georgia Latino Alliance for Human Rights (GLAHR)* and the *Florida Immigrant Coalition (FLIC)* conduct KYR workshops and have hotlines in Spanish/English for reporting ICE activity <sup>16</sup>. In Washington State, the *Washington Immigrant Solidarity Network* operates a hotline and distributes materials in Spanish and several indigenous languages <sup>17</sup>. CivicSALT could maintain a **resource list of regional hotlines** and community organizations, so users can quickly find on-the-ground support during an ICE raid or detention.
- **Indigenous Language Resources:** Recognizing that many immigrants speak neither English nor Spanish, groups like the *Mayan League* provide KYR content in indigenous languages (e.g. K’iche’, Mam, Q’anjob’al). Similarly, the Acacia Center for Justice (a new Vera-supported initiative) has produced legal guides and videos in languages such as **K’iche’, Spanish, Farsi, and Amharic** for topics like asylum and detention <sup>18</sup> <sup>19</sup>. These resources ensure that speakers of *rare or indigenous languages* can access critical information. CivicSALT should include links or content from such initiatives to be truly multilingual and inclusive.

## Immigration Bond Funds & Detention Support

When ICE detains someone, **immigration bond funds** can assist by paying the bond to secure their release. These community-driven funds exist across the country and often focus on helping those who cannot afford bond (which can range from \$1,500 to \$10,000 or more). Key resources and organizations include:

- **National Bail Fund Network – Immigration Bond Directory:** The National Bail Fund Network (via Community Justice Exchange) maintains a **directory of immigration bond funds** by state <sup>20</sup> <sup>21</sup>. It lists local funds from Arizona to Wisconsin, as well as **national funds** like the *Black Immigrants Bail Fund* and *LGBTQ Freedom Fund*. CivicSALT could link to this directory or integrate its data so users can find a bond fund relevant to their (or their loved one’s) location of detention. Each fund typically notes the region or detention centers it serves.
- **National Bond Assistance Programs:** Two prominent nationwide initiatives are:
  - **Black Immigrants Bail Fund:** A project led by the Haitian Bridge Alliance and African Communities Together, dedicated to posting bond for Black immigrants across the U.S. Its website is multilingual (English, Spanish, French, **Haitian Creole** navigation) <sup>22</sup> and it provides an online **bond assistance request form** for families in need <sup>23</sup>. This fund prioritizes vulnerable populations such as asylum seekers from African countries.
  - **LGBTQ Freedom Fund:** This fund pays immigration bonds in **every U.S. state** and bail for LGBTQ individuals in criminal custody (with a focus in FL). It seeks to free LGBTQ people who face

heightened risks in detention. The organization's materials are available in English and Spanish <sup>24</sup> <sup>25</sup> . By covering all states for ICE detention, it functions as a broad safety net for LGBTQ detainees.

- **Regional Immigration Bond Funds:** Many states or regions have at least one community bond fund. For example:

- **Florence Immigrant & Refugee Rights Project (Arizona):** Runs a bond fund for detainees in AZ <sup>26</sup> .

- **Connecticut Bail Fund – Immigrant Bail Fund:** Assists immigrants detained in New England (CT-based).

- **Prairielands Freedom Fund (Iowa):** Covers bonds in the Midwest.

- **Envision Freedom Fund (NY/NJ):** Formerly the Brooklyn Community Bail Fund, now helps release immigrants detained in the New York area.

- **First Friends of NJ & NY Bond Fund:** Supports individuals in ICE detention in New Jersey/New York <sup>27</sup> .

- **Las Vegas Family Unity Bond Fund:** Helps families pay bonds in Nevada <sup>28</sup> .

- *(For a full list, see the NBFN directory above, which includes dozens of local funds.)*

- **Accessing Bond Funds:** Typically, bond funds either have an **online intake form or a hotline**. For instance, the National Bail Fund Network provides a central **Bond Support Referral Form** (available in English and Spanish) <sup>29</sup> <sup>30</sup> . When a family fills it out with details of a detained person (including their ICE **A-number** and bond amount), the network's coordinator will attempt to connect them with a partner fund that can help <sup>31</sup> . CivicSALT could incorporate this by linking directly to the referral form or guiding users through the bond request process. This ensures users quickly find assistance in posting bond – a critical need, since release from detention greatly improves one's chances in immigration court <sup>32</sup> .

- **Detention Hotlines and Support:** Beyond bond money, organizations like **Freedom for Immigrants** operate hotlines for detainees (to report abuse or seek pro bono help) and visitation networks. While not a “bond fund,” these resources can be lifelines for those in ICE custody. For example, Freedom for Immigrants has a national hotline and can refer callers to local volunteers or legal aid <sup>33</sup> . Including such contacts in the app's detention support section can complement bond fund links by providing broader detention support (emotional support, advocacy, etc.).

All bond and support resources should be presented with clear notes on **jurisdiction** (e.g. which states or ICE facilities covered), eligibility (some funds focus on certain communities), and **contact info** (website, phone). Since many users will primarily speak languages other than English, it's important to note language capabilities; many immigration bond fund volunteers speak Spanish at minimum, and some (like the Black Immigrants Bail Fund) explicitly offer multilingual support.

## Localization of ICE-Related Guidance

**Core “Know Your Rights” advice is generally universal across the U.S.** – constitutional rights (like the right to remain silent, to refuse a warrantless search, or to speak to an attorney) apply in every state <sup>11</sup> . Guidance such as “do not open the door without a signed warrant” or “do not answer questions about your immigration status” is standard nationwide and appears in all reputable KYR materials. CivicSALT can

confidently provide a **single set of baseline instructions** for handling ICE encounters that would be accurate from California to Texas to New York. These fundamental protections come from the U.S. Constitution and federal law, so they do not change based on location.

However, **localized recommendations and resources are still important** for a few reasons:

- **State/Local Laws and Policies:** Some states and cities have “sanctuary” policies or specific laws that affect interactions with ICE. For example, state laws like California’s **AB 450** set rules for employers when ICE conducts workplace raids, and some police departments have policies not to assist ICE in the field. While the *rights* of individuals remain the same, the *context* can differ. Local KYR guides often mention these nuances (e.g. advising immigrants in Georgia vs. California might include different notes on police cooperation). Various advocacy groups produce **state-specific legal guides** – as noted by Vera Institute, resources are available for states like Arizona, Florida, Georgia, Massachusetts, Tennessee, and others <sup>26</sup>. These guides may address local agencies, relevant state programs, or community contacts, so they add value beyond the generic advice.
- **Local Emergency Hotlines and Support Networks:** In an ICE raid or arrest scenario, the most effective help often comes from local rapid response teams or hotlines. These are inherently localized – for instance, Los Angeles’s rapid response hotline (operated by CHIRLA and partners) is **(888) 624-4752**, whereas the Bay Area of California has a different number, and New York City’s hotline is another. CivicSALT should tailor the emergency contact info based on the user’s location. The app might detect or ask for the user’s city/state, then display **nearby hotline numbers, local volunteer networks, or legal clinics**. This ensures that after knowing their rights, users can act on the next step: contacting local support.
- **Languages and Community Needs:** Different regions have different prevalent languages among immigrant communities. For example, a city like Miami may require materials in Spanish and Haitian Creole; Minneapolis might have demand for Somali or Hmong translations; Los Angeles for Spanish, Korean, and Mandarin; and so on. While CivicSALT will offer major languages broadly, partnering with local organizations can help provide content in languages unique to certain communities (including indigenous languages, as mentioned). Localization could mean the app’s interface or KYR content switches to **relevant language sets** based on the user’s preference or locale. It could also mean highlighting region-specific content (for instance, a Texas user might see a note about **SB4** – a Texas law on cooperating with ICE).

**Recommendation:** The CivicSALT app should adopt a hybrid approach – present **core ICE encounter guidance that is applicable nationwide**, but also incorporate a **location-based filter** for supplemental info: - When a user signs up or opens the app, prompt them to select their state (and possibly county or city). Use this to load any specific notes (e.g. “California residents: state law limits police from assisting ICE in many cases”) and to list local resources (legal aid, advocacy groups, hotlines in that area). - Maintain a database (or use existing datasets) of *local immigrant help* – such as the state-wise resource lists compiled by Vera and others <sup>16</sup>. For example, the app can show “*Texas – here are Texas-specific immigrant rights organizations (e.g. American Gateways, RAICES), and the statewide hotline number*”. This keeps the experience relevant. - Ensure the **multilingual capability** extends to local content. If a KYR guide is available in, say, Korean for New York or Vietnamese for California, the app should link to those versions for users who prefer them.

In summary, **general ICE encounter advice is broadly applicable across the U.S., but localization enhances relevance and effectiveness.** By combining universal guidelines with location-tailored resources, CivicSALT can empower users everywhere while respecting the unique aspects of their local environment. This approach balances consistency with customization – crucial for an application meant to serve diverse immigrant communities nationwide <sup>12</sup> <sup>26</sup> .

## Sources and References

- National Immigration Legal Services Directory (Immigration Advocates Network) <sup>2</sup> – search tool for nonprofit legal aid by location, with language and case type filters.
  - Los Angeles Immigration Resources Example <sup>5</sup> <sup>34</sup> – illustrates local legal aid organizations and multilingual services.
  - Immigrant Legal Resource Center – Know Your Rights materials (Red Cards in 39 languages, family preparedness plans, etc.) <sup>6</sup> <sup>7</sup> .
  - We Have Rights Campaign – multi-language ICE encounter video series <sup>8</sup> .
  - Vera Institute “Legal Resources for Immigrants” – overview of KYR tools and state-specific guides <sup>12</sup> <sup>26</sup> .
  - United We Dream – KYR tips and preparedness steps for home, public, and workplace <sup>13</sup> <sup>14</sup> .
  - National Bail Fund Network – Directory of Immigration Bond Funds (by state) <sup>20</sup> <sup>21</sup> and Bond Referral Form <sup>29</sup> .
  - Black Immigrants Bail Fund – national bond fund (site in English/Spanish/French/Creole) <sup>22</sup> .
  - LGBTQ Freedom Fund – pays immigration bonds nationally (bilingual site) <sup>35</sup> <sup>25</sup> .
  - ACLU Know Your Rights Publications – multilingual rights pamphlets <sup>9</sup> <sup>10</sup> .
  - Excerpts of constitutional rights during ICE encounters <sup>11</sup> .
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1 National Immigration Legal Services Directory - Nonprofit Resource Center

<https://www.immigrationadvocates.org/nonprofit/legaldirectory/>

2 7 Know Your Rights | Immigrant Legal Resource Center | ILRC

<https://www.ilrc.org/community-resources/know-your-rights>

3 5 6 11 34 Comprehensive Know Your Rights Guide Against ICE Raids | Council District 14

<https://cd14.lacity.gov/community-resources/know-your-rights>

4 12 15 16 17 26 Legal Resources for Immigrants, Advocates, Journalists, and Lawmakers | Vera Institute

<https://www.vera.org/explainers/legal-resources-for-immigrants-advocates-journalists-and-lawmakers>

8 We Have Rights

<https://www.wehaverights.us/>

9 10 ACLU Issues Multi-Lingual "Know Your Rights!" Pamphlet to Educate Public | American Civil Liberties Union

<https://www.aclu.org/documents/aclu-issues-multi-lingual-know-your-rights-pamphlet-educate-public>

13 14 Know Your Rights: A Guide for Immigrants - United We Dream

<https://unitedwedream.org/resources/know-your-rights/>

18 19 Legal Guides - Acacia Center for Justice

<https://acaciajustice.org/legal-resources/resources/>

20 21 27 28 Immigration Directory — Community Justice Exchange

<https://www.communityjusticeexchange.org/en/immigration-directory>

22 23 Black Immigrants Bail Fund

<https://www.blackimmigrantsbailfund.com/>

24 25 32 35 LGBTQ Freedom Fund

<https://www.lgbtqfund.org/>

29 30 31 NBFN Bond Referral — Community Justice Exchange

<https://www.communityjusticeexchange.org/nbfn-bondreferral>

33 Resources for Immigrants Facing Detention

<https://www.freedomforimmigrants.org/resources>